

Carsten Wegscheider

University of Münster, Department of Political Science
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Academic Employment

since 10/2022	Postdoctoral Researcher and Study Program Coordinator Department of Political Science, University of Münster, Germany
10/2018 – 09/2022	Doctoral Researcher Department of Political Science, University of Salzburg, Austria
11/2019	Visiting Researcher EUROLAB, GESIS – Leibniz Institute for the Social Sciences, Cologne, Germany
10/2014 – 09/2018	Research Assistant Department of Political Science, University of Duisburg-Essen, Germany

Education

10/2018 – 09/2022	Dr. phil. in Political Science Department of Political Science, University of Salzburg, Austria
10/2016 – 09/2018	M.A. in Survey Methodology (without degree) Department of Sociology, University of Duisburg-Essen, Germany
10/2014 – 07/2017	M.A. in Theory and Comparative Studies of Political Systems in Transition Department of Political Science, University of Duisburg-Essen, Germany
02/2017 – 07/2017 02/2016 – 07/2016	Erasmus+ Visiting Student in M.A. Research Design and Social Data Analysis Department of Political Science, Babeş-Bolyai University, Cluj-Napoca, Romania
10/2011 – 12/2014	B.A. in Political Science Department of Political Science, University of Duisburg-Essen, Germany

Publications

Journal articles

- Ammassari, Sofia, Duncan McDonnell, Niklas Bolin, Annika Werner, Marco Valbruzzi, Carsten Wegscheider, Reinhard Heinisch, and Ann-Cathrine Jungar. forthcoming. "Party youth wings as forces of renovation: A study of young women members' efficacy and ambition." *Politics & Gender*. DOI: [10.1017/S1743923X26100774](https://doi.org/10.1017/S1743923X26100774).
- Ammassari, Sofia, Duncan McDonnell, Annika Werner, Reinhard Heinisch, Marco Valbruzzi, and Carsten Wegscheider. forthcoming. "More social, less material, more influenced by family ties: Why young women join political parties." *European Journal of Political Research*. DOI: [10.1017/S1475676526100978](https://doi.org/10.1017/S1475676526100978).
- Bolin, Niklas, Duncan McDonnell, Sofia Ammassari, Annika Werner, Marco Valbruzzi, Reinhard Heinisch, Ann-Cathrine Jungar, and Carsten Wegscheider. forthcoming. "The added value of youth wings: Do they nurture the members their parties want?" *Political Studies*. DOI: [10.1177/00323217261444654](https://doi.org/10.1177/00323217261444654).
- Lefkofridi, Zoe, Carsten Wegscheider, and Nadine Zwiener-Collins. 2026. "Gendered dynamics in representation: Examining candidates' policy congruence with parties and voters." *Party Politics* 32 (2): 259–273. DOI: [10.1177/13540688251332188](https://doi.org/10.1177/13540688251332188).

- Anter, Luise, Uwe Backes, Reinhard Heinisch, Steffen Kailitz, and Carsten Wegscheider. 2025. "Challenging liberal principles: Understanding of democracy among populist radical right youth leaders in Austria and Germany." *German Politics* 34 (3): 555–585. DOI: [10.1080/09644008.2024.2353071](https://doi.org/10.1080/09644008.2024.2353071).
- McDonnell, Duncan, Sofia Ammassari, Marco Valbruzzi, Niklas Bolin, Annika Werner, Reinhard Heinisch, Ann-Cathrine Jungar, and Carsten Wegscheider. 2025. "Inside party youth wings: The YOUNEM project." *Party Politics* 31 (6): 1049–1063. DOI: [10.1177/13540688241310349](https://doi.org/10.1177/13540688241310349).
- McDonnell, Duncan, Sofia Ammassari, Annika Werner, Niklas Bolin, Marco Valbruzzi, Hugo Ferrinho Lopes, Reinhard Heinisch, Ann-Cathrine Jungar, and Carsten Wegscheider. 2025. "Young radicals, moderates and aligned: Ideological congruence and incongruence in party youth wings." *European Journal of Political Research* 64 (4): 1759–1782. DOI: [10.1111/1475-6765.70000](https://doi.org/10.1111/1475-6765.70000).
- Wegscheider, Carsten, and Marlene Mauk. 2025. "Capable but not empowered? How emancipative values affect protest participation across different contexts." *Political Studies* 73 (1): 391–411. DOI: [10.1177/00323217241247377](https://doi.org/10.1177/00323217241247377).
- Fölsch, Marco, Martin Dolezal, Reinhard Heinisch, Carsten Wegscheider, and Annika Werner. 2024. "Cue-taking, populist attitudes, and support for holding a referendum: evidence from survey experiments." *Contemporary Politics* 30 (4): 553–575. DOI: [10.1080/13569775.2023.2297507](https://doi.org/10.1080/13569775.2023.2297507).
- Habersack, Fabian, and Carsten Wegscheider. 2024. "Left behind economically or politically? Economic grievances, representation, and populist attitudes." *Politics and Governance* 12: 1–15. DOI: [10.17645/pag.8567](https://doi.org/10.17645/pag.8567).
- Bucher, Hannah et al. 2023. "Special issue conclusion: The GLES Open Science Challenge 2021 in hindsight: experiences gained and lessons learned." *Politische Vierteljahresschrift* 64 (1): 207–219. DOI: [10.1007/s11615-022-00437-z](https://doi.org/10.1007/s11615-022-00437-z).
- Huber, Robert A., Michael Jankowski, and Carsten Wegscheider. 2023. "Explaining populist attitudes: The impact of policy discontent and representation." *Politische Vierteljahresschrift* 64 (1): 133–154. DOI: [10.1007/s11615-022-00422-6](https://doi.org/10.1007/s11615-022-00422-6).
- Wegscheider, Carsten, Cristóbal Rovira Kaltwasser, and Steven M. Van Hauwaert. 2023. "How citizens' conceptions of democracy relate to positive and negative partisanship towards populist parties." *West European Politics* 46 (7): 1235–1263. DOI: [10.1080/01402382.2023.2199376](https://doi.org/10.1080/01402382.2023.2199376).
- Heinisch, Reinhard, and Carsten Wegscheider. 2020. "Disentangling how populism and radical host ideologies shape citizens' conceptions of democratic decision-making." *Politics and Governance* 8 (3): 32–44. DOI: [10.17645/pag.v8i3.2915](https://doi.org/10.17645/pag.v8i3.2915).
- Wegscheider, Carsten, and Toralf Stark. 2020. "What drives citizens' evaluation of democratic performance? The interaction of citizens' democratic knowledge and institutional level of democracy." *Zeitschrift für Vergleichende Politikwissenschaft* 14 (4): 345–374. DOI: [10.1007/s12286-020-00467-0](https://doi.org/10.1007/s12286-020-00467-0).

Book chapters

- Wegscheider, Carsten, and Fabian Habersack. 2025. "Die Junge Alternative". In *Jahrbuch Extremismus & Demokratie (E & D)*, eds. Uwe Backes, Alexander Gallus, Eckhard Jesse, Tom Thieme. Baden-Baden: Nomos, 177–188. DOI: [10.5771/9783748965954-177](https://doi.org/10.5771/9783748965954-177).
- Huber, Robert A., Carsten Wegscheider, and Thomas Lehner. 2024. "Populist parties and persistent non-compliance with EU law." In *The Ideational Approach to Populism, Volume II: Consequences and Mitigation*, eds. Angelos Chrysosgelos, Eliza Tanner Hawkins, Kirk A. Hawkins, Levente Littvay, Nina Wiesehomeier. London: Routledge, 199–217. DOI: [10.4324/9781003489993-13](https://doi.org/10.4324/9781003489993-13).
- Habersack, Fabian, and Carsten Wegscheider. 2021. "Populism and Euroscepticism: Two sides of the same coin?" In *Political Populism: Handbook on Concepts, Questions and Strategies of Research*, eds. Reinhard Heinisch, Christina Holtz-Bacha, Oscar Mazzoleni. Baden-Baden: Nomos, 195–212. DOI: [10.5771/9783748907510-195](https://doi.org/10.5771/9783748907510-195).

Wegscheider, Carsten, and Roula Nezi. 2021. "Who belongs to 'the people'? The societal boundaries of national and european notions of citizenship." In *Democratic Citizenship in Flux: Conceptions of Citizenship in the Light of Political and Social Fragmentation*, eds. Markus Bayer, Oliver Schwarz, Toralf Stark. Bielefeld: transcript-Verlag, 173–192. DOI: [10.14361/9783839449493-009](https://doi.org/10.14361/9783839449493-009).

Heinisch, Reinhard, and Carsten Wegscheider. 2019. "Zum Verhältnis des Populismus zur liberalen Demokratie." In *Die Komplexität der Welt und die Sehnsucht nach Einfachheit*, ed. Martin Dürnberger. Innsbruck: Tyrolia, 107–118.

Stark, Toralf, Carsten Wegscheider, Elmar Brähler, and Oliver Decker. 2017. "Wahlurne ohne WählerInnen – eine Analyse der Ursachen für Nichtwahl in Deutschland." In *Wahlenthaltung. Zwischen Abwendung, Verdrossenheit und Desinteresse*, ed. Horst Kahrs. Berlin: Rosa-Luxemburg-Stiftung, 11–28.

Conference reports

Wurthmann, L. Constantin, Cemal Öztürk, and Carsten Wegscheider. 2016. "„Vorsicht Sicherheit! Legitimationsprobleme der Ordnung von Freiheit“ aus vergleichender Perspektive. Kongressbericht der Sektion Vergleichende Politikwissenschaft vom 26. wissenschaftlichen Kongress der Deutschen Vereinigung für Politische Wissenschaft (DVPW), 21.–25. September 2015 in Duisburg", *Zeitschrift für Vergleichende Politikwissenschaft* 9 (4): 317–333. DOI: [10.1007/s12286-016-0276-y](https://doi.org/10.1007/s12286-016-0276-y).

Online publications

Rovira Kaltwasser, Cristóbal, Carsten Wegscheider, and Steven M. Van Hauwaert. 2022. *Supporting and Rejecting Populist Parties in Western Europe*. SCRIPTS Working Paper No. 14, Berlin: Cluster of Excellence 2055 "Contestations of the Liberal Script - SCRIPTS".

Stark, Toralf, Carsten Wegscheider, Elmar Brähler, and Oliver Decker. 2017. *Sind Rechtsextremisten sozial ausgegrenzt? Eine Analyse der sozialen Lage und Einstellungen zum Rechtsextremismus*. Papers 2/2017. Berlin: Rosa-Luxemburg-Stiftung.

Awards and Grants

05/2025	Stiftungspreis der Demokratie-Stiftung (€ 5,000) awarded by Demokratie-Stiftung, University of Cologne, Germany
12/2023	Research Grant: Ideas Lab (€ 80,000) granted by University of Münster, Germany
11/2023	Dissertation Prize (€ 2,000) awarded by University of Salzburg and Rotary Club Salzburg-Nord, Austria
11/2021	Young Investigators Award (2nd Place) (€ 200) awarded by University of Salzburg, Austria
07/2021	Research Grant (€ 3,600) granted by Faculty of Cultural and Social Sciences, University of Salzburg, Austria
08/2021 08/2020	Travel Grants (€ 640) granted by Austrian Political Science Association (ÖGPW), Austria
11/2019	EUROLAB Grant (€ 1,500) granted by GESIS – Leibniz Institute for the Social Sciences, Cologne, Germany
02/2017 – 07/2017 02/2016 – 07/2016	ERASMUS+ Scholarship (€ 1,500) granted by European Commission, Luxembourg
09/2016	UDE-Scholarship (€ 300) granted by University of Duisburg-Essen, Germany

Conference and Workshop Participation

Austrian Political Science Association (ÖGPW) Political Science Day	2020, 2021
AUTNES Data Conference, University of Vienna, Austria	2019
"Citizen Perspectives on Democracy" (Workshop), University of Mainz, Germany	2024
"Current Directions in Research on Political Support", University of Duisburg-Essen, Germany	2024
Dreiländertagung (DVPW, ÖGPW & SVPW)	2019, 2023, 2026
EUROLAB Author's Conference, Cologne, Germany	2019
European Consortium for Political Research (ECPR) General Conference	2019, 2020, 2022, 2024, 2025
<i>Joint Sessions of Workshops</i>	2021, 2025
<i>Standing Group "Political Culture" Seminar Series</i>	2025
Falling Walls Science Summit, Berlin, Germany	2024
German Political Science Association (DVPW) Congress	2021, 2024
<i>Standing Group "Demokratieforschung" (Democracy Research)</i>	2018, 2019, 2021, 2023, 2025, 2026
<i>Standing Group "Wahlen und politische Einstellungen" (Elections and Political Attitudes)</i>	2021
GESIS Political Science Research Roundtable, Cologne, Germany	2019
International Political Science Association (IPSA) World Congress	2021
Pre-EPISA Workshop, University of Münster, Germany	2024
Team Populism Author's Conference, IE University Segovia, Spain	2019

Teaching Experience

University of Münster, Germany

Challenges to Politics and Public Policy	Winter 2026/27
Seminar (Bachelor), German	
Elections and Voting Behavior in the European Union	Winter 2026/27, 2025/26,
Seminar (Master), English	2024/25, 2023/24, 2022/23
Challenges of Public Governance (2x)	Summer 2026, 2025, 2024, 2023
Seminar (Bachelor), German	
Introduction to Public Governance	Winter 2024/25
Lecture (Bachelor), German	
Quantitative Methods	Winter 2023/24
Seminar (Master), German	
Political Culture and Democracy	Winter 2022/23
Reading Course (Bachelor), German	

University of Salzburg, Austria

Introduction to Comparative Politics	Summer 2022
Proseminar (Bachelor), German	
Parties, Voters and Elections	Winter 2021/22

Seminar (Bachelor & Master), German

Introduction to Political Psychology

Summer 2021; Winter 2020/21

Seminar (Bachelor & Master), German, co-taught with Lena Ramstetter

Introduction to Comparative Politics

Summer 2021; Winter 2020/21

Proseminar (Bachelor), German, co-taught with Lena Ramstetter

Introduction to Comparative Politics

Winter 2019/20; Summer 2019

Proseminar (Bachelor), German, Course Instructor: Zoe Lefkofridi

Guest Lectures on "Political Parties and Cleavages" and "Voting Behavior"

Populism in Qualitative Text Analysis

Winter 2019/20

Seminar (Master), German, Course Instructor: Reinhard Heinisch

Guest Lecture on "Content Analysis"

Why is there no agreement on European asylum policy?

Winter 2019/20

Workshop (Pupils University), German

Research Design

Summer 2019

Seminar (Master), English, Course Instructor: Reinhard Heinisch

Guest Lectures on "Qualitative Research: Coding and Text Analysis" and "Presentations"

Political Campaigning

Summer 2019

Seminar (Master), English, Course Instructor: Reinhard Heinisch

Guest Lecture on "Presentations"

Comparative Populism

Winter 2018/19

Seminar (Master), English, Course Instructor: Reinhard Heinisch

Guest Lecture on "Populism and Communication"

Syria Conflict: Why is a solution so difficult?

Winter 2018/19

Workshop (Pupils University), German

University of Duisburg-Essen, Germany

Measuring the Understanding of Democracy with International Surveys

Winter 2017/18, 2016/17

Civil Society in Eastern Europe

Winter 2015/16

Seminar (Master), German & English, Course Instructor: Susanne Pickel

Teaching Assistant, Annual Excursion to Babeş-Bolyai University, Cluj-Napoca, Romania

Statistics for Political Science

Summer 2015

Tutorial (Bachelor), German, Course Instructor: Achim Goerres

Research Experience

05/2024 – 10/2024

[GESIS Panel \(Wave 1c\)](#): Questionnaire design of a survey module on "Public attitudes towards party bans in Germany"; GESIS – Leibniz Institute for the Social Sciences, Cologne, Germany

01/2024 – 12/2025

[Mapping \(Anti-\)Globalization Attitudes \(MAGA\)](#) (Principal Investigator): Development of a multidimensional measurement of globalization attitudes and spatial analysis via geo-coded survey; University of Münster, Germany

10/2021 – 06/2022

[ProConEU](#) & [Euromanifesto Study](#): Manual coding of Austrian party manifestos for 2019 European Parliament election; Ludwig Maximilian University of Munich, Germany & Mannheim Centre for European Social Research (MZES), University of Mannheim, Germany

03/2021 – 04/2021	Europeanising the elections of the European Parliament : Data collection and report writing on electoral law, ballots, results and party information for 2019 European Parliament election in Austria; European University Institute (EUI), Italy
12/2020 – 06/2022	Youth Wing Membership Survey (YOUMEM) Project : Design and implementation of online surveys among centre-left and centre-right youth wings in Austria and Germany; University of Salzburg, Austria
03/2020 – 07/2020	Making Tomorrow's Leaders: Youth Movements of Right Wing Populist Parties : Qualitative elite interviews, data collection and online survey with Austrian Freedom Party (Freiheitliche Partei Österreichs/FPÖ) youth organization "Ring Freiheitlicher Jugend" (RFJ); Swedish Research Council, Sweden
02/2019 – 05/2019	euand2019 Voting-Advice-Application : Manual coding of Austrian party positions for 2019 European Parliament election; European University Institute (EUI), Italy
11/2018 – 03/2019	Austrian National Election Study (AUTNES) Online Panel Study 2017–2019 (Wave 7) : Questionnaire design of a survey module on "Understanding of Representative Democracy in Austria: Causes and Consequences"; Vienna Center for Electoral Research (VieCER), University of Vienna, Austria
10/2018 – 11/2018	The One Percent Problem: Muslims in the West and the Rise of the New Populists : Qualitative elite interviews with Austrian Freedom Party (Freiheitliche Partei Österreichs/FPÖ) officials; Brookings Institution, Washington, D.C., USA

Media Coverage and Blogs

"Bewusstsein für kritische Infrastruktur steigt." [Deutschlandfunk](#), 11.01.2026.

"'Generation Deutschland', ou quand la jeunesse de l'AfD fait mine de s'acheter une conduite." [France 24](#), 02.12.2025.

"Mehr Information, weniger Emotion: Polit-Profis diskutieren mit Schülern am Alde." [Soester Anzeiger](#), 14.02.2025.

"Rechtsradikale Parolen – Verharmlosung und Strafbarkeit." [Radio Q](#), 13.07.2024.

"Demokratiefördergesetz: Ampel will mit Geld Demokratie fördern – Gegner wittern Gedankenpolizei." [20 Minuten](#), 27.02.2024.

"Radio Fluchtpunkt: Rechtspopulismus." [Antenne Münster](#), 07.11.2023.

Dingler, Sarah, Fabian Habersack, Reinhard Heinisch, Zoe Lefkofridi, and Carsten Wegscheider. 2019. "EU-Wahl: Wie finde ich heraus, wer meine politische Position vertritt?" [ÖGPW Political Science Blog – derStandard.at](#).

Additional Academic Training

04/2024	Introduction to Geospatial Techniques for Social Scientists in R GESIS Training, GESIS – Leibniz Institute for the Social Sciences, Cologne, Germany
11/2018 – 10/2021	Third-Party Funding Management (Zertifikatsprogramm "Drittmittelführerschein"), University of Salzburg, Austria
08/2021	Scaling Methods for Social Science: Measurement and Ideal Point Estimation for Surveys and Behavior Essex Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis, Virtual Summer School
03/2019 – 07/2021	HSD+ Certification in University Didactics

(HSD+ Hochschuldidaktik Lehrgang), University of Salzburg, Austria

03/2021	Multilevel Structural Equation Modelling ECPR Winter School in Methods and Techniques, Virtual Winter School
07/2020 – 08/2020	Causal Inference and Experiments in the Social Sciences Essex Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis, Virtual Summer School
02/2020	Maximum Likelihood Estimation; Introduction to Bayesian Inference; Introduction to Machine Learning for the Social Sciences ECPR Winter School in Methods and Techniques, University of Bamberg, Germany
02/2019 – 03/2019	Introduction to R; Multilevel Regression Modelling; Structural Equation Modelling (SEM) with R ECPR Winter School in Methods and Techniques, University of Bamberg, Germany

Professional Service and Memberships

University Committees:	Appointment Committee for the W3 Professorship in "Political Science with a focus on International Sustainability Policy", University of Münster (since 04/2025); Ethics Committee, Faculty of Education and Social Sciences, University of Münster (since 01/2024); Study Advisory Board, Faculty of Education and Social Sciences, University of Münster (since 10/2022); Department Council, Department of Political Science, University of Salzburg (12/2019 – 09/2022)
Professional Service:	Speaker, Standing Group "Demokratieforschung" (<i>Democracy Research</i>), German Political Science Association (DVPW) (since 09/2021)
Professional Associations:	German Political Science Association (DVPW) (since 03/2021) Austrian Political Science Association (ÖGPW) (12/2018 – 12/2024) International Society of Political Psychology (ISPP) (02/2021 – 02/2022) International Political Science Association (IPSA) (03/2021 – 12/2021)
Reviewer:	American Political Science Review, Analyses of Social Issues and Public Policy, Australian Journal of Political Science (2), British Journal of Political Science (3), Comparative European Politics, Contemporary Politics, Democratization, European Journal of Political Research (4), European Politics and Society, European Political Science Review, Humanities and Social Sciences Communications, International Journal of Sociology, Journal of Political Sociology, Journal of Politics, Party Politics, Policy Studies, Political Behavior, Political Research Exchange (5), Political Research Quarterly, Political Studies, Political Studies Review (2), Politische Vierteljahresschrift, Representation, West European Politics (2), Zeitschrift für Vergleichende Politikwissenschaft

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